

Template Guidelines

NONTECHNICAL SLIDE REDESIGN, UPDATED 2025

Purpose

To create a highly functional, adaptable, yet consistent template of slides that showcases cohesion and brand identity for diverse user groups: researchers, research translation and administrative teams, and other OI associates.

Guiding Principles

- **Usability**

A primary function of this template deck is to increase efficiency and reduce complexity in the process of slide deck creation. In the past, slides are often carried over from past decks (some “signature slides” are included in most presentations and their content is not generally changed) and if new content is created, the formatting guidelines have not been clear. This template deck serves to

1) create new standardized versions of signature slides that can be used and reused without the content changing, and

2) provide a set template for different types of slides identified in past presentations, so that new content created has specific guidelines to adhere to.

- **Consistency**

OI has established brand guidelines for materials such as nontechnical documents, website design, etc., but in the past, these guidelines have been inconsistently used for slides. Since these brand guidelines were established after many signature slides had already been created, they were not necessarily retroactively applied and have resulted in inconsistencies within decks.

This template deck uses many of the specifications laid out in the Opportunity Insights Brand DNA document (including color scheme, fonts, and overall aesthetic) and applies them to the deck format. Key consistencies here include the following (more details can be found in the Text and Design Specifications section of this document): margin size, text hierarchy, font color and type, use of logo and source section, line widths, and icons.

- **Clarity**



An organization-wide goal of talks and presentations is to disseminate OI's research to a wide range of audiences for purposes including informing practitioners (such as policymakers), reaching academics and diverse student groups, and funding future development.

While slide decks should maintain consistency across the board, we've identified cases where audience-dependent adjustments can be made. For example, a "key findings" callout box is useful in clarifying the main point of a chart or table for a non-academic audience, but academic audiences may not necessarily need that addition. The addition of narrative text, thoughtful highlighting, and enhanced information visualization can increase the audience's understanding of the research and improve talk engagement.

- **Longevity**

Tying together all previous guiding principles, the hope for this template deck is to provide a highly functional deck that can stand the test of time and aid presentation creation in the long-term. Ideally, the functionality of this deck is such that its adoption quickly becomes status quo and thus any future deck creation can start from a consistently formatted origin.

Text Specifications

Slide title – Lucida Bright, Size 24, Bolded

Slide subtitle – Lucida Sans, Size 16, #626365

Section titles (>1 map, graph, icon set; newspaper article or policy titles) – Lucida Bright, Size 16, Bolded

Primary text (bullet points) – Lucida Sans, min. size 16, max. size 24

(Source within a bullet point) – Lucida Sans, min. size 16, max. size 24, Parenthesized, #626365

Descriptive text (Axes labels, axes titles, Key Findings primary text, descriptive text [ie. Subtitle of a map label], table content, dates on newspaper article or policy) – Lucida Sans, Size 16

Legend text [graph label text if smaller size is needed] – Lucida Sans, Size 16



Pull quotes – Lucida Sans, Size 16, Italicized

Source – Lucida Sans, Size 14, hyperlink to paper, reset text to black

Newspaper or policy excerpt – Lucida Bright, Size 16

Design Specifications

Line weight – 0.5 (aqua header, source footer, axes, labels)

Highlight – 75% transparency

Icons – sourced from [Font Awesome](#) (solid)

Image captures of SoCap or Opportunity Atlas - remove the title header and footer, set to same width as source footer, add legend in bottom right corner over a white box (with 40% transparency)

